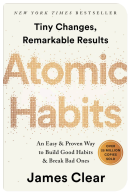
Read only these chapters

Every chapter verdict from The Useful Library. 12 books. By Raja, who reads 70+ nonfiction books a year.



Atomic Habits

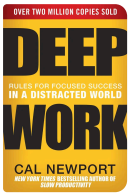
James Clear · read 6 of 20

READ 1. The Surprising Power of Atomic Habits, 2. How Your Habits Shape Your Identity (and Vice Versa), 3. How to Build Better Habits in 4 Simple Steps, 5. The Best Way to Start a New Habit, 13. How to Stop Procrastinating by Using the Two-Minute Rule, 16. How to Stick with Good Habits Every Day

SKIM 4. The Man Who Didn't Look Right, 6. Motivation Is Overrated; Environment Often Matters More, 7. The Secret to Self-Control, 8. How to Make a Habit Irresistible, 10. How to Find and Fix the Causes of Your Bad Habits, 11. Walk Slowly, but Never Backward, 12. The Law of Least Effort, 14. How to Make Good Habits Inevitable and Bad Habits Impossible, 15. The Cardinal Rule of Behavior Change, 19. The Goldilocks Rule: How to Stay Motivated in Life and Work

Worth it, but not cover to cover. 6 chapters carry the whole system.

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Deep Work

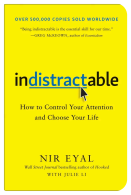
Cal Newport · read 3 of 9

READ Rule 1: Work Deeply, Rule 2: Embrace Boredom, Rule 4: Drain the Shallows

SKIM Introduction, 1. Deep Work Is Valuable, Rule 3: Quit Social Media

Read rules 1, 2 and 4, skim the rest. Part 1 argues for focus at length; Part 2 tells you how to do it.

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Indistractable

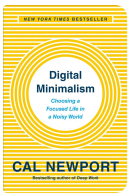
Nir Eyal · read 3 of 7

READ Part 1: Master Internal Triggers, Part 2: Make Time for Traction, Part 4: Prevent Distraction with Pacts

SKIM Part 3: Hack Back External Triggers, Part 5: Make Your Workplace Indistractable, Part 7: Have Indistractable Relationships

Read parts 1, 2 and 4. They hold the whole method; the rest applies it to work, kids and relationships.

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Digital Minimalism

Cal Newport · read 3 of 7

READ 3. The Digital Declutter, 4. Spend Time Alone, 6. Reclaim Leisure

SKIM 1. A Lopsided Arms Race, 2. Digital Minimalism, 5. Don't Click Like, 7. Join the Attention Resistance

Read chapters 3, 4 and 6. The declutter plus what to fill the time with.

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Meditations

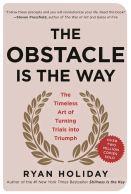
Marcus Aurelius · read 4 of 12

READ Book 2, Book 4, Book 5, Book 8

SKIM Book 3, Book 6, Book 7, Book 9, Book 10, Book 11, Book 12

Start with Books 2, 4, 5 and 8. The other books repeat the same ideas in new words, which is the point, but not where to start.

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The Obstacle Is the Way

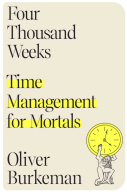
Ryan Holiday · read 2 of 5

READ Part 1: Perception, Part 2: Action

SKIM Introduction, Part 3: Will

Read Parts 1 and 2. They turn Stoicism into a method: see clearly, then act.

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Four Thousand Weeks

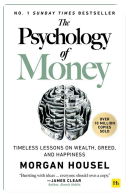
Oliver Burkeman · read 6 of 17

READ Introduction: In the Long Run, We're All Dead, 1. The Limit-Embracing Life, 2. The Efficiency Trap, 4. Becoming a Better Procrastinator, 7. We Never Really Have Time, Appendix: Ten Tools

SKIM 3. Facing Finitude, 5. The Watermelon Problem, 6. The Intimate Interrupter, 8. You Are Here, 9. Rediscovering Rest, 10. The Impatience Spiral, 11. Staying on the Bus, 13. Cosmic Insignificance Therapy

Read the introduction, chapters 1, 2, 4 and 7, and the 10 tools at the end. That's the whole argument plus what to do with it.

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The Psychology of Money

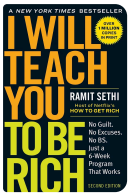
Morgan Housel · read 6 of 20

READ 4. Confounding Compounding, 5. Getting Wealthy vs. Staying Wealthy, 8. Man in the Car Paradox, 9. Wealth is What You Don't See, 10. Save Money, 13. Room for Error

SKIM 1. No One's Crazy, 2. Luck & Risk, 3. Never Enough, 6. Tails, You Win, 7. Freedom, 11. Reasonable > Rational, 12. Surprise!, 14. You'll Change, 15. Nothing's Free, 16. You & Me, 19. All Together Now, 20. Confessions

Read 6 of the 20 short chapters. They hold the ideas that change how you spend and save.

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I Will Teach You to Be Rich

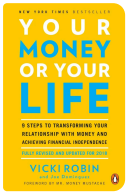
Ramit Sethi · read 3 of 10

READ 4. Conscious Spending, 5. Save While Sleeping, 6. The Myth of Financial Expertise

SKIM 1. Optimize Your Credit Cards, 2. Beat the Banks, 3. Get Ready to Invest, 7. Investing Isn't Only for Rich People, 8. Easy Maintenance, 9. A Rich Life

Read chapters 4, 5 and 6 wherever you live. Much of the rest is built around US banks, cards and accounts.

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Your Money or Your Life

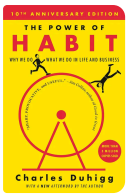
Vicki Robin and Joe Dominguez · read 4 of 9

READ Step 2: Being in the present, Step 3: Where is it all going?, Step 4: Three questions, Step 8: Capital and the crossover point

SKIM Step 1: Making peace with the past, Step 5: Making life energy visible, Step 6: Valuing your life energy, spending, Step 7: Valuing your life energy, income

Do steps 2, 3, 4 and 8. They turn money into hours of your life, which changes how small buys feel.

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The Power of Habit

Charles Duhigg · read 6 of 11

READ 1. The Habit Loop: How Habits Work, 2. The Craving Brain: How to Create New Habits, 3. The Golden Rule of Habit Change: Why Transformation Occurs, 4. Keystone Habits, or The Ballad of Paul O'Neill: Which Habits Matter Most, 5. Starbucks and the Habit of Success: When Willpower Becomes Automatic, Appendix: A Reader's Guide to Using These Ideas

SKIM Prologue: The Habit Cure, 7. How Target Knows What You Want Before You Do: When Companies Predict (and Manipulate) Habits, 9. The Neurology of Free Will: Are We Responsible for Our Habits?

Read chapters 1 to 5 and the appendix. The rest is about companies and social movements: good stories, less to use.

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Tiny Habits

BJ Fogg · read 4 of 10

READ 1. The Elements of Behavior, 3. Ability: Easy Does It, 4. Prompts: The Power of After, 5. Emotions Create Habits

SKIM Introduction: Change Can Be Easy (and Fun), 2. Motivation: Focus on Matching, 6. Growing Your Habits: From Tiny to Transformative, 7. Untangling Bad Habits: A Systematic Solution

Read chapters 1, 3, 4 and 5. They hold the whole method; the rest grows it and applies it to bad habits and groups.

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